MERLIK FOUNDATION

Q1 2026

QUARTERLY REPORT

January – March 2026

Service · Responsibility · Integrity

4 Programmes | 30+ Boys Mentored | 4 Partner Organizations | 3 Counties Reached

Founder's Note

Q1 2026 has been a quarter of intentional growth — from the inside out.

We began the year by investing deeply in our coaches — the men who stand in front of our boys every session. The three-part mental health workshop series with Paper Hearts Foundation was not just training; it was a declaration that to pour into young men, we must first pour into ourselves.

We extended our reach to new communities — Paula Mercy Children's Home in Uthiru and our ongoing program at United Matunda Academy in Uasin Gishu, where 30 boys are now actively engaged in structured mentorship. We also stepped into broader conversations at the Imaginable Futures convening, planting seeds for collaborations that will shape the next chapter of our work.

To every coach, partner, parent, and supporter — your belief in this mission makes the work possible. Together, we are restoring order to the hearts of men.

Sheila Ngui
Founder & Executive Director
Merlik Foundation

APRIL 2026
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01 | Company Information

Incorporated	4 September 2019
Mission	Empowerment of the Boy Child through Education, Mentorship and General Life Development
Vision	Strengthening and Developing Nations one boy at a time

Core Values	Service | Responsibility | Integrity
Mantra	Restoring Order to the Hearts of Men
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02 Mental Health Workshop Series

Overview

Programme	Capacity Building — Mental Health Awareness
Dates	11th, 18th & 25th February 2026
Format	Virtual — Google Meet (3 Sessions)
Facilitator	Nelima Baraza — Psychologist & Founder, Paper Hearts Foundation
Target Group	Mission Partners / Coaches
Session Fee	KES 500 per participant per session
Attendance	Session 1: 17 | Session 2: 15 | Session 3: 10

Session Summaries

Session 1 — 11 February 2026: Introduction to Mental Health & Gender Dynamics

- Team introductions and check-ins; new member Joy on boarded
- Mental health defined as peace of mind, content heart, and easygoing nature
- Explored gender differences in emotional expression — cultural and masculinity barriers
- Identifying distress signals: behavioral and energy shifts in boys
- Outcome: Coaches gained awareness of how cultural norms suppress emotional expression in boys

Session 2 — 18 February 2026: Trauma-Informed Frameworks & Emotional Intelligence

- Introduction to trauma-informed care principles and their application in youth mentorship
- Emotional intelligence tools for recognizing and responding to boys in distress
- Practical scenarios for coaches dealing with complex behavioral presentations
- Building resilience frameworks coaches can apply in field sessions
- Outcome: Coaches equipped with structured frameworks for trauma-sensitive engagement

Session 3 — 25 February 2026: Safe Spaces, Emotional Intelligence & Accountability

- Safe space defined: an environment for sharing without judgment
- Team self-rated emotional safety at 7.5/10 — areas for growth identified
- Emotional intelligence: extending grace to ourselves as coaches as we do to the boys
- Scenario-based training: responding to disclosures of abuse (child and adult)
- Personality diversity leveraged as a team strength
- Outcome: Team explored emotional accountability, conflict management, and practical response frameworks

Key Findings & Outcomes

- Coaches developed a shared language around mental health and trauma-informed care
- Increased confidence in recognizing distress signals — behavioral and energy shifts — in boys
- Cultural barriers to emotional expression in male mentorship contexts identified and addressed
- Team committed to ongoing accountability: personality testing and peer learning via WhatsApp
- Follow-up: planning the next capacity building series; applying EQ frameworks in field missions

Photo Placeholder

Action Plan

Action Point	Person Responsible	Timeline
Plan and schedule next capacity building series	Merlik Foundation Coaches	Q2 2026
Conduct personality testing for coaching team	Merlik Foundation	Within 4 weeks
Apply emotional intelligence frameworks in all field missions	All Coaches	Ongoing

03 United Matunda Academy — Mentorship Program

Programme Overview

Location	United Matunda Academy & Orphanage, Uasin Gishu County
Coaches	Kamanda Calvin & Clement Wambulwa
Beneficiaries	30 boys (25 current students + 5 senior school alumni)
Current Pillar	Pillar One: Purpose and Identity
Mission Cost	KES 8,640
Reporting Period	February – March 2026
Session Time	3:00 pm – 4:00 pm (weekly)

February Sessions

Two mentorship sessions were conducted in February, both facilitated by Calvin and Clement.

Session 1 — 3rd February 2026: Introduction to Purpose & Identity

- Introduced the theme of Pillar One: Purpose and Identity
- Boys guided through discussions on self-awareness, values, and the importance of understanding oneself early in life
- Social Worker Mike co-facilitated alongside Calvin

Session 2 — 17th February 2026: Personal Values & Identity Formation

- Continued exploration of personal values and how they shape daily decisions
- Boys encouraged to reflect on whether they consistently practice the values they hold
- Many boys openly acknowledged struggling to fully live by their stated values in all situations

Senior School Engagement — 27th February 2026

- A separate session was held with the 5 senior school alumni during their half-term break
- Reconnected these boys with the program; they shared experiences and challenges from senior school
- This maintained mentorship continuity beyond the primary school cohort

March Sessions

Two sessions were conducted in March, completing the core sessions of Pillar One.

Session 1 — Goal Setting (10th March 2026)

- Boys guided on translating their understanding of identity and purpose into clear, achievable goals
- Emphasis placed on discipline and consistency in pursuing goals

Session 2 — Online Guest Speaker (24th March 2026)

- Eric Mungai facilitated an online session on Purpose and Identity
- Sheila Ngui also participated in the session alongside the boys
- Session was partially affected by power and internet instability at the school
- Despite interruptions, the guest speaker assigned two reflection exercises for follow-up

Key Findings

- Boys are gradually developing self-awareness and beginning to connect identity with purpose and goal setting
- Senior school alumni demonstrate strong understanding of purpose and identity concepts
- Boys demonstrated honesty about the gap between their stated values and their daily behavior — a positive sign of reflective growth
- Attendance has been consistent; boys look forward to sessions, particularly the refreshment time which strengthens peer bonds
- The interactive and discussion-based format continues to create a safe and open space for sharing

Observed Gaps

- Some boys are still developing self-awareness and find it difficult to clearly define who they are and what they stand for
- Visible gap between understanding good values and consistently practicing them
- Some boys are uncertain about future goals and direction in life
- A number of boys are still building confidence to share personal challenges openly — continued trust-building is required
- Technical infrastructure at the school (power and internet) affected online session delivery

Photo Placeholder

Facilitator's Note

> *The February mentorship sessions initiated meaningful conversations about identity, values, and goal setting. As the program continues, we are optimistic that we will help the boys reach a point where they become more reflective about their behavior and life choices. The continued support from Merlik Foundation remains essential in sustaining this program.*
>
> — Kamanda Calvin, Mentorship Facilitator — United Matunda Academy

Next Steps

- Conduct one to two additional sessions with senior school boys to finalize Pillar One
- Follow up on assignments given by guest speaker Eric Mungai
- Begin Pillar Two with the full cohort once Pillar One is formally completed
- Calvin and Clement to organize individual support sessions for junior school boys who need additional guidance

Action Plan

Action Point	Person Responsible	Timeline
Finalize Pillar One: follow-up sessions with senior school boys	Kamanda Calvin	April 2026
Follow up on assignments given by guest speaker	Calvin & Boys	April 2026
Plan for Pillar Two commencement	Merlik Foundation & UMA Coaches	April/May 2026
Address power/internet challenges for online sessions	United Matunda Academy	Before next online session

04 Imaginable Futures Convening

Overview

Date	26th March 2026
Venue	Entim Sidai Wellness Sanctuary, Karen, Nairobi County
Host	Imaginable Futures
Representative	Jacob Miano — Merlik Foundation
Mission Cost	KES 2,500
Purpose	Expanding the collaborators network with other CBOs

Background

Merlik Foundation was invited by Imaginable Futures — a global organization focused on reimagining education and youth development — to participate in a convening centered on redefining what it means for young people to truly thrive. The engagement moved beyond traditional skills-based approaches to explore purpose, identity, mental wellbeing, and the social environments that shape youth outcomes.

The event allowed Merlik Foundation to contribute practical insights from frontline mentorship while initiating conversations around future collaboration with Imaginable Futures and Firelight Foundation.

Photo Placeholder

Key Findings

- Strategic government collaboration must balance alignment with public structures while maintaining organizational independence and mission integrity
- Youth with shared lived experiences bring authenticity that significantly enhances mentorship outcomes
- Clear value in forming a CBO consortium for shared resources and best practices
- Many CBOs lack capacity to navigate power dynamics with authorities — intentional strengthening required

Challenges & Resolutions

Challenges:

- Limited documentation of Merlik Foundation's work and impact — much exists only as lived experience
- Limited structured evidence to demonstrate scalability to potential partners

Resolutions:

- Adopt intentional documentation practices through video interviews with beneficiaries and stakeholders
- Develop a clear proof of concept: consolidate outcomes, testimonials, and measurable indicators

Action Plan

Action Point	Person Responsible	Timeline
Explore collaboration with Imaginable Futures & Firelight Foundation	Merlik Foundation Partnerships	Within 1 month
Follow up and receive report from Imaginable Futures	Merlik Foundation & Imaginable Futures	Within 2 weeks
Begin beneficiary documentation drive	Merlik Foundation	Q2 2026

05 Paula Mercy Children's Home Mission — Uthiru

Overview

Date	21st March 2026
Venue	Paula Mercy Children's Home, Uthiru, Kiambu County
Partner	Seeds of Tomorrow
Mission Cost	KES 4,652
Team	Sheila Ngui, Shema Mpyisi, Jacob Miano, Job Mithanga, Yvonne Kituku
Report Written By	Yvonne Kituku | Supervisor sign-off: 27th March 2026

Background

On 21st March 2026, Merlik Foundation collaborated with Seeds of Tomorrow at Paula Mercy Children's Home. Sessions focused on self-awareness, confidence building, and goal setting. The boys demonstrated strong peer bonds and a clear grasp of personal development concepts, with aspirations ranging across football, mechanics, riding, and architecture.

Photo Placeholder

Key Findings

- Strong kid-to-kid bond evident throughout sessions — boys showed care and attentiveness to one another
- Boys demonstrated clear understanding of self-awareness, confidence building, and goal setting
- Diverse aspirations: football, mechanics, riders, and architecture

- Strong peer dynamics identified as a significant strength to be leveraged by both organizations

Challenges & Resolutions

Challenges:

- Age differences made uniform content delivery difficult
- Caregivers pulling boys out mid-session for chores
- Some boys were uneasy and distracted

Resolutions:

- Divide boys into age-appropriate groups for future sessions
- Coordinate with facility to schedule chores before or after sessions
- Create a neutral, confidential environment to build trust and openness

Supervisor's Note

> *This is an opportunity we should also look into and expand the scope of our mentorship program. I recommend more collaboration of this kind — together we create a monarch of empowered men.*
>
> — Supervisor, 27th March 2026

Action Plan

Action Point	Person Responsible	Timeline
Send full program details to facility before next visit	Seeds of Tomorrow & Merlik Foundation	Two weeks prior
Address career guidance needs of the boys	Merlik Foundation, Seeds of Tomorrow & School Admin	To be agreed
Allocate adequate time for future sessions	School administration	To be agreed

06 Partnerships Update

Active Partnerships — Q1 2026

United Matunda Academy, Uasin Gishu County

Formal mentorship program launched in Q4 2025 with 30 enrolled beneficiaries. Regular weekly sessions commenced in 2026 with coaches Kamanda Calvin and Clement Wambulwa. Pillar One (Purpose & Identity) currently underway with strong attendance and growing engagement.

Seeds of Tomorrow

Active collaboration at Paula Mercy Children's Home, Uthiru — first joint mentorship session completed in March 2026 with plans to scale. Shared mission around community building, children's home support, and youth empowerment.

Paper Hearts Foundation

Ongoing collaboration — Nelima Baraza (Psychologist & Founder) facilitated the full three-part Mental Health Workshop Series in February 2026, equipping coaches with professional-grade psychosocial tools.

Imaginable Futures & Firelight Foundation

New partnership conversations initiated at the Entim Sidai Wellness Sanctuary convening on 26th March 2026. Follow-up engagement in progress to explore joint programmes.

07 Closing Note

To our incredible stakeholders, supporters, donors, and partners —

Thank you for making our mission possible. Your generosity, dedication, and unwavering belief in our work continue to transform lives and strengthen communities across Kenya.

Q1 2026 has demonstrated the power of intentional programming — from building the inner capacity of our coaches, to expanding the reach of our mentorship to new communities, to positioning Merlik Foundation within broader national and global networks of youth development.

As we step into Q2, we carry forward the lessons, the relationships, and the momentum that this quarter has given us. Together, we continue restoring order to the hearts of men — one boy at a time.

Sheila Ngui

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